

Aay Preston-Myint: *Curriculum vitae*

b. 1981, New York | Lives and works in Oakland, Calif.

Currently:

Independent Curator, Designer, and Artist.

Curatorial Council, Southern Exposure. 2021-present.

Board of Directors, Small Press Traffic. 2021-present.

Sometimes:

Adjunct Faculty, California College of the Arts. 2021-present.

Formerly:

Executive Director, SF Camerawork. 2023-2024.

Senior Manager, Public Program, Headlands Center for the Arts. 2018-2022.

Founder & Co-Director, the Chicago Art Book Fair. 2016-2019.

Adjunct Associate Professor, School of the Art Institute of Chicago. 2012-2018.

Organizer, Chances Dances. 2005-2018.

Co-Founder, No Coast / No Coast Editions. 2008-2017.

Editor-in-Chief, Monsters and Dust. 2009-2014.

MFA, University of Chicago, 2011

BFA, School of the Art Institute of Chicago, 2006

Selected exhibitions, engagements, and awards:

2025

Curator, *Black Life* series, Berkeley Art Museum/Pacific Film Archive, Berkeley, Calif.

2024

Co-Curator, *High Five* art festival, Edge on the Square, San Francisco

Curator, *Ebti: Ma-kan* / مکان. SF Camerawork, San Francisco

2023

Curator, *Charles Lee: sweat + dirt*. SF Camerawork, San Francisco

Exhibiting Artist, *New Moon Figure Eight*, 120710, Berkeley, Calif.

Curator, *Weep to Water the Trees*. slash, San Francisco

2022

Curator, *Dewdrops in the Garden*. Southern Exposure, San Francisco

Exhibiting Artist, *All that glows in the dark of democracy*. Weinberg Newton, Chicago

2021

Artist in Residence, In Cahoots, Petaluma, Calif.

Artist in Residence, Facebook Open Arts, Menlo Park, Calif.

2020

Exhibiting Artist, *Residency Projects In Flux*, Kala Art Center, Berkeley.

Curator, *Tomorrow Is Already Here*, Headlands Center for the Arts, Sausalito, Calif.

2019

Director, the Chicago Art Book Fair. Multiple venues, Chicago. (since 2017)

Exhibiting Artist, *contrapposto*. Victoria Arts Council, Victoria, B.C.

X O. Royal Nonesuch, Oakland. (solo exhibition)

Exhibiting Artist, *Slant Step Forward*. Verge Center for the Arts, Sacramento.

Recipient, Kala Fellowship Award. Kala Art Institute, Berkeley.

***Wormhole*. Adler & Floyd, Chicago.** (solo exhibition)

Exhibiting Artist, *Love*, Aswang. Southern Exposure, San Francisco.

Exhibiting Artist, *Ruffles, Ritual and Repair*. Wedding Cake House, Providence.

2018

Exhibiting Artist, *Artists + Archives: Pilots*. Leather Archives & Museum, Chicago.

***Trinity [Project #11]. 'sindikiti*, Baltimore.** (solo exhibition)

Exhibiting Artist, *An Image for A Vessel*. Gaylord and Dorothy Donnelley Foundation, Chicago.

2017

Artist in Residence (with Latham Zearfoss), Radiant Hall/The Residence, Pittsburgh.

Exhibiting Artist, *One day this kid will get larger*. DePaul Art Museum, Chicago.

2016

Exhibiting Artist, *Gist and Gesture*. Kavi Gupta, Chicago.

***Aay Preston-Myint for Trunk Show*. Trunk Show, Chicago.** (solo exhibition)

2015

Recipient, Art Matters Discretionary Grant. (as Chances Dances)

Performing Artist, *Intersite Visual Arts Festival*. Various locations, Calgary. (as Chances Dances)

Exhibiting Artist, *Frontier*. Sometimes Art Space, Havana.

Organizer and Curator, *Platforms: Ten Years of Chances Dances*. Multiple venues, Chicago.

Exhibiting Artist, *Terrain Biennial*. Various locations, Oak Park, Ill.

2014

Curator, *Boundaries, Collapse*. Lula, Chicago.

Exhibiting Artist, *The [New] New Corpse*. Sector 2337, Chicago.

Artist in Residence, Summer Forum for Inquiry and Exchange. Joshua Tree, Calif.

2013

Organizer, *Summoning a New Queer Reality*. Museum of Contemporary Art, Chicago. (At Night, I Think Of You). Threewalls, Chicago (solo exhibition)
Exhibiting Artist, *How Do I Look?* Roots and Culture, Chicago.

2012

Exhibiting Artist, *All Good Things are Born Wild and Free*. Carthage College, Kenosha, Wisc.
Exhibiting Artist, *Bowling Alone*. Andrew Rafacz, Chicago.
Exhibiting Artist, *Joan Mitchell 2011 MFA Grant Exhibition*. CUE Art Foundation, New York.
***I'm Here to Make Friends*. Happy Collaborationists, Chicago.** (solo exhibition)

2011

Recipient, Propeller Fund (a Warhol Regional Regranting Program).
Recipient, Joan Mitchell MFA Grant.

2010

Artist in residence, ACRE. Steuben, Wisc.
Exhibiting Artist, *Suggestions of a Life Being Lived*. SF Camerawork, San Francisco.

2009

Recipient, University of Illinois at Chicago Lincoln Fellowship.
***SMILE*. Heaven Gallery, Chicago.** (solo exhibition)
Channeling: An Invocation of Queer Spirits and Spectral Bodies. London Gay & Lesbian Film Festival.

2008

Chicago Short Film Brigade: Best of 2007. Gene Siskel Film Center, Chicago.
Keyholder, Mess Hall, Chicago (through 2011).

2007

Exhibiting Artist, *Positive Space/Negative Feelings*. Brown Triangle, Chicago.
Art Shanty Projects Exhibition and Residency. Medicine Lake, Plymouth, Minn.

Selected Bibliography & Design Work:

Catalogue Design, *ReSOURCE: Art and Resourcefulness in Black Chicago*. Publisher: South Side Community Art Center, 2024.

Catalogue essay for *Dewdrops in the Garden*, Publisher: Southern Exposure, 2022

Catalogue Design, *EMERGENCE: Intersections at the Center*. Publisher: South Side Community Art Center, 2020.

Catalogue and Exhibition Design, *Tomorrow Is Already Here*. Publisher: Headlands Center for the Arts, 2020.

Micah Salkind, *Do You Remember House? Chicago's Queer of Color Undergrounds*. Oxford Univ. Press, 2019.

Catalogue and Exhibition Design, *The Time is Now! Art Worlds of Chicago's South Side 1960-1980*.

Rebecca Zorach and Marissa H. Baker, eds. Publisher: Univ. of Chicago Press, 2018

"Artist of the Week: Aay Preston-Myint." LVL3, January 2018 [↗](#)

Publisher/Curator, No Coast Editions, 2013-2017.

Daniel Quiles, "Critics' Picks: Chicago." Arforum.com, February 2017 [↗](#)

"Fire Signs." *Dilettante Vol. 2: Joshua Tree*. 2016

Ariel Goldberg, *The Estrangement Principle*. Nightboat Books, 2016.

Editor, *Platforms: Ten Years of Chances Dances*. Publisher: Chances, December 2015.

Editor, *Body Doubles*. Publisher: Museum of Contemporary Art Chicago, November 2014

Editor-in-chief, *Monsters and Dust*. Self-published. Four issues, 2009-2014

Alicia Eler, "A Space Where Identity Politics Give Way to Queer Minimalism." Hyperallergic.com, May 2013 [↗](#)

Jason Fournberg, ed., "Art 50: Chicago's Artist's Artists." *NewCity*, Sept. 2012 [↗](#)

Designer and printer, Green Lantern Press. Multiple publications, 2011

Caroline Picard, "Alchemical Processes." Bad At Sports blog, June 2011 [↗](#)

Katie Zien, "Prestidigitation." *No Commercial Value*, May 2010 [↗](#)

Bert Stabler, "Critic's Choice: *Smile*." *Chicago Reader*, Jan. 2008

Aleks Tomaszewska, "Hidden Light." *Mule Magazine*, March 2007

Jennifer Brandel, "Soft Shop on the Crackling Ice." 848 (Chicago Public Radio WBEZ), Feb. 2007 [↗](#)

Jessica Hopper, "Never Mind Lime Wire." *Chicago Reader*, Aug. 2005